RLHP is committed to:

- *Child-Centred Integrated Community Development.*
- *Child Rights and Child Development Programmes in Urban and Rural Areas.*
- *Eradication of Child Labour and Mainstreaming Children into Formal Education.*
- *Prevention of Child Marriage and Child Abuse to Protect Children Rights*
- *Promoting Children's Participation at Home, in Schools, Communities and Local Governance.*
- *Promoting and Encouraging Girl Children Education.*
- *Library Programmes for Government School Children.*
- *Sponsorship Programmes for Children.*
- *Child Helpline Service (1098) for Children in Difficult Circumstances (2011–2024).*
- *Campaign Against Child Labour at Regional, State and National Levels through Networking.*
- *Rehabilitation Homes for Children in Need of Care and Protection (Girls and Boys).*
- *Education and Health Support for Children of Migrant Families*
- *Adolescents Empowerment Programmes.*
- *Youth Development Programmes*
- *Socio-Economic and Livelihood Development and Empowerment for Women in Rural and Urban Areas.*
- *Community Based Health and Sanitation Programmes*
- *Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn and Child Health (RMNCH)*
- *Prevention of Malnutrition.*
- *Eco-Friendly Activities and Environmental Conservation Programmes for Children, Youth and Communities.*
- *Livelihood Programmes for Rural Communities (MGNREGA, NRLM).*
- *Humanitarian Assistance During Emergencies and Disasters (Floods, Tsunami and COVID-19).*
- *Development Initiatives for People in Aspiration Districts' and Regions.*
- *Reaching the Unreached through Inclusive Development Programmes and Linkage with Government Schemes and Services.*
- *Networking and Collaboration with Government Departments and Other Stakeholders for Community Development.*

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FOREWORD

It gives immense pleasure to present the 42nd annual report for the year 2025-26 which reflects the journey, achievements, challenges and continued commitment of the society for Rural Literacy and Health Programme (RLHP). The year under review is packed with remarkable developments. We hope to share a glimpse of those moments which shaped the destiny of the marginalized people in four districts of Karnataka- Mysuru, Chamarajanagar, Kalaburagi and Bidar.

Our initiatives in key areas like child welfare and safeguarding, education, healthcare, livelihood, gender equality, empowerment of women and adolescent girls' youth engagement in environment issues etc. have enabled us to reach out to around one million people and create opportunities for positive and sustainable change. Every achievement reflected in this report is the result of collective effort and the trust placed in our organisation.

We would like to express our sincere appreciation to all partners who stood with us throughout our journey and who have been so supportive to make a tangible difference in the lives of people who are deeply disadvantaged. Few names to mention here are Wipro Foundation, Azim Premji Philanthropic Initiatives (APPI), Klüber Lubrications Pvt. Ltd., TDH(G)-BMZ, ChildFund International, Mission Inde and many more individual donors. We look forward to their continued patronage.

I sincerely thank our dedicated team, community members, supporters, donors, volunteers, and institutional partners for their invaluable contribution. Together, we remain committed to building a more equitable, inclusive, and sustainable society.

I invite you to read this report and join us in our continued journey of service and transformative interventions.

Prof. Jose V.K
Secretary, RLHP, Mysuru.

INTRODUCTION

With over 42 years of dedicated service, the Rural Literacy and Health Programme (RLHP) has remained committed to improving the lives of marginalized and vulnerable communities by promoting inclusive, equitable, and sustainable development. Through its child-centred integrated community development approach, RLHP works closely with communities, government departments, and civil society organizations to strengthen local capacities, uphold the rights of children, women, adolescents, youth, and vulnerable groups, and create opportunities that enable individuals and families to lead safe, healthy, and dignified lives.

During the reporting period, RLHP implemented its programmes across four districts of Karnataka-Mysuru, Bidar, Kalaburagi, and Chamarajanagar—reaching more than 9.7 lakh people. The organization operates through four project offices located in Mysuru, Chincholi, Basavakalyana, and Gundlupete, with the head office in Mysuru providing strategic leadership, programme coordination, technical guidance, and administrative support. This structure enabled effective implementation, coordination, and monitoring of various interventions across the project locations.

RLHP's integrated programmes address the diverse needs of marginalized and vulnerable communities through interventions in child protection, education, health, nutrition, livelihoods, women's empowerment, and community development. Key initiatives included care and rehabilitation for children in need of care and protection, mainstreaming out-of-school and child labourers into formal education, vocational and life skills training for adolescent girls and women, and awareness programmes on child rights, gender equality, health, and social inclusion.

The organization also strengthened livelihoods for vulnerable families and smallholder farmers while improving the health and nutritional status of pregnant women, lactating mothers, and children through community-based interventions and better access to essential services. At the grassroots level, RLHP empowered community institutions such as Village Health, Sanitation and Nutrition Committees (VHSNCs), School Development and Monitoring Committees (SDMCs), Self-Help Groups (SHGs), and Women and Child Protection Committees (WCPCs) to enhance community participation, strengthen local governance, and improve access to government schemes and public services.

RLHP further strengthened its collaboration with government departments and partner organizations, including CACL, Mythri, FEVORD-K, MSDF, and DWANI, promoting knowledge sharing, awareness, and collective action for child rights and community development. Through these integrated and participatory efforts, RLHP continues to empower marginalized and vulnerable communities, enabling them to build resilient livelihoods, protect children's rights, and create a more just, inclusive, and sustainable society.



1. CHILD DEVELOPMENT

1.1 CHILDREN IN DIFFICULT CIRCUSTANCES

(ASHA BHAVANA AND ASHA KIRANA)



With a strong commitment to the care, protection, and empowerment of vulnerable children, the Rural Literacy and Health Programme (RLHP), Mysuru, operates two residential shelter homes-Asha Kirana Boys' Shelter Home and Asha Bhavana Girls' Shelter Home, providing a safe, nurturing, and child-friendly environment for children in need of care and protection. During the reporting period, the two shelter homes in Mysuru provided comprehensive care and rehabilitation support to 44 children (21 boys and 23 girls), ensuring access to education, healthcare, nutrition, counselling, life skills, and opportunities for overall development.

Educational excellence remained a key priority across both shelter homes, with all children enrolled in formal schools, colleges, and vocational institutions. Regular academic support, remedial coaching, digital learning resources, and continuous progress monitoring helped strengthen learning outcomes and ensure timely guidance for every child.

The academic performance of the children during the reporting period was encouraging. Six students successfully passed the SSLC examination, including one girl who secured 90%. One boy studying in 1st PUC secured 443 marks, while three boys received awards for 100% school attendance, reflecting their commitment to education. One girl pursuing a Diploma in Electrical and Electronics Engineering secured 70% in the first semester. In addition, one girl is pursuing in final year BA degree, while two girls are pursuing paramedical courses, reflecting the shelter homes continued commitment to promoting higher education and career development.

The shelter homes prioritized children's physical and emotional well-being through balanced nutrition, monthly health check-ups, counselling services, and timely medical care. Daily routines included Yoga, Pranayama, Karate, Aerobics, meditation, physical exercise, and newspaper reading, promoting discipline, confidence, and healthy lifestyles. Nutritious meals, health supplements, and regular growth monitoring ensured the children's overall well-being.

RLHP adopted a child-centred approach by

encouraging children to participate actively in decision-making through regular children's meetings and committees on food, health, sports, cleanliness, and kitchen gardening. These platforms strengthened leadership, communication, teamwork, responsibility, and life skills while promoting children's participation in managing their daily routines. To support comprehensive development, children actively participated in cultural, creative, and recreational activities, including Kamsale, Dollu Kunitha, Bharatanatyam, Charkha craft, drawing, painting, drama, music, traditional folk arts, and dance performances. Summer camps, Dasara camps, competitions, games, and cultural programmes provided opportunities to develop creativity, confidence, and social skills.



From Adversity to Aspiration: Monika's Journey

Monika lost her father at a young age. After her mother's remarriage, she experienced sexual abuse by her stepfather and was brought under the care and protection of the Child Welfare Committee (CWC) through a POCSO case. Monika was enrolled at Asha Bhavana through the CWC in 2025, where she received care, protection, counselling and a safe environment. RLHP supported her education and helped her regain confidence and focus on her studies.

With the support of RLHP, Monika successfully completed her 10th Standard with distinction. She is now pursuing PCMB at a private college and is determined to achieve her dream of becoming a doctor.

Environmental education formed an integral part of the programme. Children maintained kitchen gardens, cultivated vegetables, and learned sustainable practices such as vermicomposting, Jeevamrutha preparation, nursery development, and waste segregation. Educational exposure visits to historical, cultural, and educational institutions, along with participation in state and national-level programmes on child rights, youth leadership, and environmental conservation, broadened their knowledge and confidence.

During the year, RLHP also strengthened the shelter homes infrastructure by improving sanitation facilities, renovating buildings, upgrading washrooms, painting child-friendly spaces, and providing educational and recreational resources, including digital learning equipment and essential household facilities.

In addition, through CSR initiatives, Asha Kirana and Asha Bhavana Shelter Homes in Mysuru were upgraded through building renovations, improved facilities, sanitation and washroom improvements, and the creation of safe and child-friendly spaces. Digital learning facilities were also strengthened through the installation of televisions for audio-visual learning, making education more interactive, engaging, and joyful for children.

Through its integrated, child-centred approach, RLHP continues to provide vulnerable children with a safe and supportive environment that promotes education, protection, health, and life skills, empowering them to become confident, self-reliant, and responsible individuals capable of building a dignified future.

From Vulnerability to Independence: Prashanth's Journey

Prashanth, from Kalyanagiri, Mysuru, lost both his parents at a young age and was admitted to Asha Kirana Boys' Shelter Home at the age of seven. He was initially malnourished, and the shelter provided him with proper care, nutrition, education and a safe environment. He also developed an interest in kitchen gardening and actively participated in sports, particularly kabaddi.

Despite learning challenges, Prashanth successfully completed his SSLC with 437 marks. With support from RLHP, he completed a two-year vocational course in two-wheeler repair at Hunsur and is now working as a mechanic at a TVS showroom in Mysuru, earning a regular monthly income of Rs.14,000. He lives independently in a single rented room and is leading a dignified and self-reliant life, with aspirations of opening his own garage in the future.

1.2. CHILDREN EDUCATION AND DEVELOPMENT

RLHP remained committed to the integrated development of marginalized children from disadvantaged communities by promoting access to quality education, healthcare, meaningful participation, protection, and overall well-being. Through its child-centred interventions, the organization has empowered children to become active participants in shaping their own future and contributing to the development of their communities.

Child Rights Clubs (CRCs) have become vibrant platforms for nurturing child leadership, awareness, and participation. Currently, RLHP has 145 Child Rights Clubs with more than 5,000 active child members across its project areas. Regular trainings and workshops were conducted on the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC), the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, the Juvenile Justice (JJ) Act, the Right to Education (RTE) Act, the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006, the Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986 (as amended in 2016), and the Children's Gram Sabha. These sessions strengthened children's understanding of their rights and responsibilities while enhancing their confidence to identify local issues, engage with community institutions, and participate effectively in civic processes.

Throughout the year, CRC members actively participated in school programmes, Gram Panchayat meetings, Children's Gram Sabhas, SDMC meetings, community awareness campaigns, summer camps, press meets, Anti-Child Labour Day programmes, and Children's Samsthas conducted annually. Through these platforms, children raised concerns related to education, child protection, school



infrastructure, sanitation, safety, and other community issues, demonstrating leadership and meaningful participation in local decision-making.

As a result, RLHP strengthened child protection systems and community ownership of child rights by promoting school enrolment and regular attendance, preventing child labour and child marriage, and encouraging children's participation in community governance. Through sustained awareness campaigns, capacity-building initiatives, and collaboration with Gram Panchayats, Women and Child Protection Committees, schools, Childline, and other stakeholders, the programme strengthened community-based protection mechanisms, improved access to education, and contributed to creating safer, more inclusive environments where children can learn, participate, and succeed.



1.3. CHILDREN'S SPECIAL GRAMA SABHAS

With the collective efforts of Child Rights Clubs (CRCs) and the continuous support of RLHP, several Gram Panchayats organized Special Children's Gram Sabhas, providing children with a platform to raise concerns related to education, WASH, school sanitation, toilets, drinking water, safety, child labour, child marriage, and child protection.

The active participation of children and the concerns they raised resulted in several significant improvements at the community level. Based on the issues highlighted during the Children's Gram Sabhas, school surroundings were cleaned, school buildings were renovated and painted, toilets were constructed, playgrounds were improved, drinking water facilities and water connections for school toilets were provided, borewells were repaired, compound walls were constructed, CCTV cameras were installed to enhance school safety, and drainage works were undertaken to improve sanitation. Concerns related to waterlogging, mosquito breeding, and unsafe conditions around schools were also addressed through the timely intervention of Gram Panchayats and line departments.

Children's participation in local governance increased, and they became more confident in identifying, raising, and reporting community concerns. Issues related to WASH, sanitation, child labour, and child marriage were brought to the attention of relevant authorities for timely action. The process also promoted positive behavioural changes among children and communities regarding hygiene, sanitation, toilet use, cleanliness, child protection, and education. These efforts contributed to safer, healthier, and more child-friendly learning and community environments.



1.4. JOYFUL LEARNING ACTIVITIES (CRC CENTRES)



To prevent child labour, child marriage, and school dropouts during the summer vacation, RLHP conducted Summer Camps across its rural and urban project areas, providing children with a safe, inclusive, and engaging environment.

The camps included a wide range of creative, educational, recreational, sports, and cultural activities such as drawing, painting, mask-making, paper crafts, storytelling, action songs, games, sports competitions, street plays, group discussions, and cultural performances. Awareness sessions on child rights, health and hygiene, sanitation, environmental protection, personal safety, gender equality, civic responsibility, and the importance of education were also conducted. These activities enabled children to learn through play, express their creativity, explore their talents, and develop confidence, teamwork, communication, and leadership skills.

The Summer Camps provided a safe, inclusive, and child-friendly environment where children could spend their holidays meaningfully while strengthening peer interaction and social inclusion. The camps also helped identify vulnerable children, encourage regular school attendance, and motivate children to continue their education. By engaging children in positive and productive activities during the vacation, the programme helped reduce their vulnerability to child labour, child marriage, and school dropout. More than 12,000 children participated in and benefited from the Summer Camps during the reporting period.

1.5. CHILD-FRIENDLY GOVERNMENT SCHOOL ENVIRONMENTS WITH INNOVATION AND DIGITALIZATION

During 2025–26, RLHP, with support from CSR initiatives, continued its commitment to strengthening child-friendly learning environments and improving educational outcomes across its project areas. The programme focused on enhancing access to quality education, strengthening school infrastructure, and creating inclusive learning opportunities that support children's academic progress and overall development.

A total of 1,200 students benefited from essential educational support, including learning materials, uniforms, and digital learning resources. At Government Higher Primary and High School, Hanchya, digital education



was strengthened through the appointment of a computer teacher and the introduction of regular computer classes. A multipurpose classroom was also constructed at the school to address space constraints and provide additional facilities for

academic and co-curricular activities. These interventions helped create a more supportive learning environment while enabling students to develop essential digital skills and increase their confidence in using technology.



RLHP also provided academic support to 110 academically strong Class 8 students from rural areas. The students received NMMS coaching, guidance, and learning materials to strengthen their examination preparation. Each selected student is eligible to receive a scholarship of Rs.10,000 per year for four years, amounting to Rs. 40,000 per student. The total potential scholarship support for the 110 students is Rs. 44 lakh, contributing to their continued education. Sanitary pad disposal machines were provided to government schools to support the safe and hygienic disposal of used sanitary pads and promote improved menstrual waste management.

These initiatives benefited more than 12,000 students and children across the project areas by improving access to educational support, enhancing learning experiences, strengthening digital literacy, and creating safer and more supportive school environments. The interventions contributed to children's confidence, well-being, and overall development while supporting their continued educational journey.

1.6. MYSURU CHILD DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME (MCDP)

Rural Literacy and Health Programme (RLHP), Mysuru, through the Mysore Child Development Programme (MCDP), continues to work towards improving the lives of children and families living in Mysuru Urban Slums. The programme is being implemented across 16 locations, reaching 1,117 children and benefiting a wider population of 7,10,621 individuals. MCDP follows a child-centred and integrated community development approach, focusing on key areas such as education, health, livelihood promotion, child protection, and community empowerment.



Health: - During the 2025–26 financial year, the organization successfully implemented 216 impactful community-based activities under the Health thematic area. These comprehensive programs focused on critical wellness and awareness topics, including Sexual and Reproductive Health (SRH) education for adolescents, mothers, ASHA workers, and Anganwadi staff, as well as targeted college campaigns addressing teenage pregnancy and child marriage. Additionally, the initiative utilized diverse engagement strategies such as interactive handwashing and personal hygiene demonstrations, street plays for Mental Health Day, Informational, Education, and

Communication (IEC) materials on family planning, and Primary Health Centre wall paintings depicting the risks of early pregnancy. Key observances like Nutrition Food Day, Menstrual Hygiene Day, and International Women's Day were also celebrated to strengthen community engagement.

These initiatives drove significant, positive behavioural shifts across the target populations. Adolescents and adults increasingly adopted safe menstrual hygiene and broader sanitation practices, while parents began prioritizing nutritious home-cooked meals over junk food for their children. The visual wall paintings reached an estimated 700,000 individuals, drastically raising public awareness surrounding teenage pregnancy. Furthermore, the street plays effectively reduced local stigma, leading community members with mental health concerns to come forward for professional referral and treatment.

Education/Learning: - During the 2025–26 financial year, the organization successfully implemented 254 impactful community-based activities under the Education thematic area. These comprehensive initiatives focused on enhancing access to quality learning and empowering local stakeholders through Child Resource Centres (CRCs), School Enrolment Jathas, Right to Education (RTE) awareness sessions for parents, capacity-building workshops for School Development and Monitoring Committees (SDMCs), and targeted teacher training. Creative and holistic student development was fostered through Art Corners in schools, Radio Programmes, seasonal camps (Summer and Dasara), and flagship celebrations like Chinnara Chilipili (Children's Day). Furthermore, essential interventions included targeted campaigns promoting girl child education, the distribution of education kits, and systematic learning assessments using the Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) test tool.



These activities generated direct, measurable improvements across school enrolment, academic progress, and community-led governance. Strategic outreach enabled the re-enrolment and mainstreaming of 15 child labour and dropouts and irregular students while encouraging 35 children to transfer from private to government schools. The CRCs provided critical academic support, contributing to a drop in attrition, while ASER testing confirmed significant gains in foundational literacy and numeracy for 308 out of 329 assessed children. Seasonal camps effectively prevented seasonal dropouts and child labour, simultaneously nurturing talent in crafts, drawing, and performing arts. Events like Chinnara Chilipili provided a platform for students to showcase regional art forms, including Dollu Kunitha, Kamsale, Maragalu Kunitha, and drama. Finally, SDMC workshops empowered committee members to actively monitor school operations, directly leading to major infrastructure upgrades such as boundary wall construction, toilet repairs, reliable drinking water access, and improved Mid-Day Meal quality.

Livelihood : - During the 2025–26 financial year, the organization successfully implemented 112 impactful community-based activities under the Livelihood thematic area. These comprehensive interventions focused on

economic empowerment, youth development, and civic engagement through Entrepreneurship Development Programme (EDP) training for women, tailoring workshops, and vocational and computer courses for young people. Programmatic efforts were further enriched through modules on life skills, financial literacy, career guidance, exposure visits, radio programs, and facilitating access to social security schemes and academic scholarships. To foster civic responsibility and active citizenship, the initiative also organized Sports Day, National Youth Day observances, and awareness rallies addressing critical social issues.

These multidimensional programs generated significant socio-economic outcomes across the community. Under the Income Generation Programme (IGP), 50 women completed livelihood training, with 15 receiving seed funding to launch micro-enterprises—such as tailoring shops, retail petty shops, eateries, and flower vending—substantially boosting their household incomes. Vocational skill initiatives enabled nine youths to complete specialized training in car driving, beautician services, and modern technology applications, while targeted career guidance encouraged 30 students to pursue higher education aligned with their career ambitions. Furthermore, financial literacy sessions instilled disciplined saving habits and mindful spending among young participants. Beyond economic gains, the initiatives empowered youth to lead local advocacy efforts against drug abuse and municipal infrastructure gaps, while National Youth Day activities mobilized 150 participants in sports and rallies to condemn gender-based violence and promote mutual respect for women.

Lekhana D. – Building A Self-Reliant Future

Lekhana D., aged 23 years, has been a ChildFund-sponsored child for the past 15 years. She grew up without parental support and was cared for by others before finding stability with her elder brother. Despite financial difficulties, she completed her B. Com degree and developed an interest in the beauty and wellness sector.

Recognizing her potential, RLHP under MCDP supported Lekhana to undergo a specialized beautician course. The training helped her develop professional skills and confidence to pursue her passion as a livelihood. Today, she independently provides beauty services in her community and earns a steady monthly income of Rs. 4,000 – Rs. 5,000. With a growing number of customers and encouragement from friends, she is planning to establish her own beauty parlour. She is thankful to ChildFund and RLHP for the opportunity and support that have helped her move towards financial independence.

Child Protection: - During the 2025–26 financial year, the organization successfully implemented 131 impactful community-based activities under the Child Protection thematic area. These comprehensive programs focused on establishing safe environments and institutional safeguards through strengthening Ward and Village Level Child Protection Committees (WLCPCs/VLCPCs), conducting Safe and Unsafe Touch workshops in schools, and delivering capacity-building training on safeguarding policies for beneficiaries and key stakeholders, including ASHA workers, Anganwadi staff, and Police Health Officers (PHOs). The initiative also fostered multi-sectoral collaboration through coordination meetings with key government departments—such as the Juvenile Justice Board (JJB), Child



Welfare Committee (CWC), and District Child Protection Unit (DCPU)—alongside radio broadcasts, street plays on child rights violations, distribution of Information, Education, and Communication (IEC) materials, parent sensitization sessions, National Girl Child Day observances, and dedicated campaigns against child marriage and teenage pregnancy.

These strategic efforts created widespread community awareness, empowering local residents and committee members to actively identify and report child protection violations to official helplines such as 1098 and 112. Key interventions successfully prevented 4 child marriages, reported 3 Child Sexual Abuse (CSA) cases under POCSO, secured government hostel accommodation for 3 vulnerable children, and linked 5 children to financial sponsorship schemes. Furthermore, active WLCPC members took strong local leadership to monitor and address community-level risks, effectively tackling school dropouts, child labour, substance abuse, and hazardous local infrastructure to ensure a safer environment for children.

2. ADOLESCENT EMPOWERMENT AND YOUTH DEVLEOPMENT

2.1. ADOLESLCENT GIRLS GROUP FORMATION AND CAPACITY BUILDING

RLHP made significant progress in empowering adolescent girls in Gundlupete Taluk of Chamarajanagar District, while expanding its interventions to Chincholi Taluk of Kalaburagi District and Basavakalyana Taluk of Bidar District in North Karnataka. These regions continue to face challenges such as limited awareness of girls' education, school dropout, child marriage, child protection concerns, gender-based discrimination, violence against women, poverty, inadequate school infrastructure, limited transportation, and deeply rooted social practices. Girls from marginalized communities, including Lambani tandas, often face additional barriers to education, health, and personal development.

To address these challenges, RLHP promoted awareness of key child and women protection laws, including the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act (PCMA), POCSO Act, Juvenile Justice (JJ) Act, Child Labour Prohibition and



Regulation Act (CLPRA), Right to Education (RTE) Act, and Right to Information (RTI) Act.

These interventions strengthened adolescents' and community members' understanding of their rights, responsibilities, and available legal safeguards.

Breaking Barriers Through Kamsale

Bannithalapura village, located 12 km from Gundlupete, has 1,090 households and a population of 4,080, with agriculture as the main livelihood. RLHP has been working in the village for the past four years, engaging women, children, adolescent girls, and youth through community groups. During a group meeting, the adolescent girls expressed their interest in learning Kamsale, a traditional folk art. Despite facing social resistance and traditional beliefs that girls should not perform Kamsale, the girls continued their practice with encouragement and support from RLHP.

Their dedication soon turned into a remarkable achievement, securing first prize at the Hobli and Taluk levels and third prize at the district level. They later performed at Rangayana Theatre, Mysuru, before district-level officers and received appreciation for their performance. Their success helped change community perceptions and challenged traditional gender stereotypes, demonstrating how providing girls with opportunities, encouragement, and a supportive platform can build confidence, showcase their talents, and inspire positive change in the community.

During 2025–26, RLHP supported adolescent girls to continue their education, develop livelihood skills, access government services, and respond to challenges affecting their well-being and future opportunities. The programme was implemented across 65 villages, reaching 5,239 adolescent girls through sensitization and capacity-building programmes, girls' group meetings, vocational training, exposure visits, and community-based interventions.

A total of 640 girls were re-enrolled in education. Through timely reporting and intervention, 22 child marriages were prevented, while eight child abuse cases were reported and addressed under the POCSO Act. RLHP provided crisis intervention and protection support to 574 girls facing child sexual abuse, trafficking, domestic violence, child and forced marriage, and child labour, including counselling, education, legal and medical assistance, shelter, and linkages to appropriate services. A total of 532 girls accessed relevant public services, entitlements, and government schemes, including scholarships, essential documentation, and other welfare services. 865 girls demonstrated improved health-seeking behaviour, adoption of safe menstrual hygiene practices, and access to public health centres, adolescent health services, and other healthcare support. To promote a safe, healthy, and child-friendly learning environment, RLHP supported



19 schools with WASH (Water, Sanitation and Hygiene) facilities. The intervention focused on improving access to safe drinking water, sanitation facilities, and hygiene practices among students and school staff. Along with infrastructure support, students were encouraged to adopt regular handwashing, personal hygiene, and proper sanitation practices. These efforts contributed to creating cleaner and healthier school environments, reducing health risks, and promoting better attendance and overall well-being among children.

Collective leadership and participation were strengthened through adolescent girls' groups, with 1,734 girls organized and 66 peer leaders actively engaged in the programme. Together, they undertook community initiatives addressing issues such as school dropout, child marriage, access to government schemes, drinking water, sanitation, school infrastructure, electricity, and transportation. Through these efforts, girls raised community concerns and worked with local authorities to promote positive change. The programme strengthened adolescent girls' ability to continue their education, develop livelihood skills, access public services, seek timely support, and participate in community decision-making. The growing participation of girls and peer leaders contributed to challenging restrictive gender norms, promoting child protection, and creating greater opportunities for girls to exercise their rights and pursue their educational, personal, and livelihood aspirations.

From Financial Challenges to Higher Education

Bhagyashree, a 19-year-old from Partapur village, lost her father at a young age, leaving her mother, an ASHA worker, as the family's sole breadwinner. Despite financial challenges, Bhagyashree excelled academically, scoring 97% in Second PUC. As a member of the RLHP adolescent girls group member, she shared her dream of pursuing higher education but was worried about the cost of college.

Recognizing her potential, RLHP supported her in applying for scholarships and approaching the Partapur Gram Panchayat for financial assistance. With support in preparing the required documents and submitting her application, Bhagyashree received a Rs.5,000 education grant from the Gram Panchayat, enabling her to continue her higher education. This timely support helped her continue her studies without interruption. Today, she is pursuing B.A. (Second Semester) and serves as the president of the adolescent girls group, actively participating in community activities and encouraging other girls to pursue higher education. Her journey demonstrates how timely guidance, opportunities, and community support can help girls overcome financial barriers and move confidently towards their aspirations.

2.2. LIFE SKILLS AND VOCATIONAL TRAINING

To promote the empowerment and mainstreaming of underprivileged out-of-school adolescent girls and boys, RLHP conducted various vocational training programmes in areas such as tailoring and embroidery, driving, and computer skills. In addition to technical skills, participants were provided with capacity-building sessions on life skills, soft skills, community development, environmental protection, personality development, career guidance, and employability skills to enhance their confidence, personal growth, and preparedness for livelihood opportunities.

During the reporting period, 283 adolescent girls and young women successfully completed vocational training in different skill areas. Among them, 107 participants gained employment or started self-employment activities, earning between Rs.8,000 and Rs.12,000 per month. These initiatives have enabled young women to become financially independent, improve their confidence, develop sustainable livelihoods, and contribute positively to their families and communities.



2.3. GENDER AND JUSTICE – RIGHT TO PLAY



To mark Right to Play Day, RLHP organized special sports events in Basavakalyana and Chincholi to encourage adolescent girls to overcome gender barriers and promote equal participation in sports. Around 600 adolescent girls participated in games such as Kabaddi, Cricket, Volleyball, Tug of War, Buguri, and Running Races.

More than 490 adolescent girls challenged traditional gender norms by participating in sports teams and competing at school, taluk, and district-level events. Through participation in gender-inclusive sports and cultural activities, girls-built self-confidence, teamwork, leadership, communication, and decision-making skills while promoting gender equality and healthy lifestyles.

The programme also encouraged parents, teachers, and community members to support girls' participation in sports. By excelling in sports traditionally considered male-dominated, girls challenged stereotypes, emerged as role models, and reinforced the message that every girl has an equal right to play, participate, compete, and succeed.

2.4 YOUTH ENGAGEMENT IN CLIMATE CHANGE



The Youth Climate Initiative led by RLHP is creating a wide and growing impact across Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu. A total of 105 youth groups are actively leading local initiatives to promote environmental sustainability. More than 1,850 young leaders were trained in climate science, environmental protection, and leadership through workshops, exposure visits, climate libraries, and capacity-building programmes.



Their influence has extended from the district to the national level, including key contributions to General Comment No. 26 on children's rights and the environment. These youth-led initiatives respond to real environmental challenges. Notable actions include river clean-up drives at the Kapila River in Nanjangud, solid waste management initiatives in Mysuru, and widespread climate awareness campaigns. By participating in international observances such as Earth Day, World Environment Day, Youth Day, Voice for Green Earth campaigns, and Global Action Month, these young changemakers have successfully amplified their voices on a global stage.

During Global Action Month, the initiative mobilized youth to reach over 11,700 students through creative awareness activities, including street plays, debates, and art. This awareness was translated into practical action, as volunteers produced cloth bags to reduce plastic pollution and created seed balls for reforestation. Through collective advocacy and a strong sense of purpose, RLHP's youth are breaking stereotypes and actively shaping policies to ensure a greener and more sustainable future for Karnataka.

During the reporting period, RLHP brought together youth across Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu to promote environmental conservation through Nature-Based Solutions (NBS). In Karnataka, an organic coconut oil production unit was established; in Andhra Pradesh, a fishery-based initiative was undertaken; and in Tamil Nadu, a millet-based production unit was established. These initiatives provided livelihood and income opportunities for local youth while encouraging their active participation in environmental conservation and sustainable development.

RLHP, in collaboration with Bengaluru University, Jnana Bharathi Campus, organized a State-Level Workshop on Environmental Protection, Climate Change, and Sustainable Development, inaugurated by Shri Eshwara B. Khandre, Hon'ble Cabinet Minister for Forest, Ecology and Environment, Karnataka. The workshop covered biodiversity conservation, plastic waste management, water conservation, rainwater harvesting and environmental justice. Through expert sessions and panel discussions, youth were encouraged to take active responsibility for environmental protection, participate in governance and adopt sustainable practices. RLHP youth also raised concerns on Chamundi Hills conservation, plastic pollution and sustainable transportation, strengthening their role as young environmental advocates. The workshop emphasized the importance of youth-led environmental action and community participation. Participants were encouraged to promote practical solutions and build a sustainable and climate-resilient future.

2.5. ENGAGING CHILDREN FOR ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION (GREEN TEAMS)

During the reporting period, RLHP initiated Green Teams in 25 schools, conducting 49 environmental and nutrition awareness sessions reaching 11,500 children. The sessions focused on environmental conservation, climate responsibility, sustainable living, nutrition, kitchen gardening, and waste management through practical and interactive activities.

Green Team members adopted eco-friendly practices in their schools, homes, and communities by reducing plastic use and promoting alternatives such as cloth and paper bags. They also learned about conserving water, soil, and plants and actively participated in tree plantation, cleanliness drives, and other environmental protection activities.

School and Anganwadi kitchen gardens provided children with practical experience in





sustainable food production and healthy eating. The gardens produced 56 kg of brinjal, 29 kg of radish, 51 kg of tomatoes, 24 kg of beans, 14 kg of chilli, and 35 kg of green leafy vegetables, which were used in mid-day meals to improve children's nutritional intake. Children also established kitchen gardens at home, growing ridge gourd, bottle gourd, ash gourd, brinjal, and cucumber.

In addition, solid waste segregation was introduced in 15 schools, helping children understand responsible waste management and reduce environmental pollution. Through tree plantation, protection of green spaces, kitchen gardening, and other practical activities, the Green Team initiative strengthened children's environmental awareness and encouraged them to become active environmental stewards in their schools, homes, and communities.

3. WOMEN EMPOWERMENT AND CAPACITY BUILDING

3.1. WOMEN RIGHTS- SHGs

Through the Dhwani and Belaku Women's Federations, RLHP conducted capacity-building programmes to strengthen women's knowledge, leadership, health, protection, and socio-economic empowerment. The trainings covered Entrepreneurship Development Programme (EDP), SHG strengthening, MGNREGA, NULM, NRLM, leadership development, gender equality, the 73rd Constitutional Amendment, and access to government schemes. Sessions also addressed domestic violence, prevention of violence against women and girls, anaemia,



reproductive health, immunization, mental health, child marriage, girls' education, POCSO, and legal rights. These programmes enhanced women's awareness, confidence, decision-making abilities, and capacity to access livelihood opportunities, protect their rights, and participate actively in family and community development.

Women's federations played a proactive role in addressing community issues by resolving family disputes, responding to cases of domestic violence, and supporting survivors of abuse through timely coordination with the police, Childline, and other concerned authorities. They also advocated for housing rights by identifying infrastructure and housing-related issues in urban areas and submitting petitions to the Karnataka Slum Development Board. In collaboration with the Women's Violence Prevention Forum and other stakeholders, the federations actively promoted gender justice and community-led action against violence.

As a result of these collective efforts, women's groups played a vital role in preventing 16 child marriages, resolving 27 domestic violence cases, and resolved 26 family disputes through counselling. RLHP further strengthened women's participation in local governance and economic development by forming and supporting 250 Self-Help Groups (SHGs). More than 12,000 women were linked to various government welfare schemes through awareness and capacity-building programmes. Under the Sanjeevini (NRLM) programme, 75 newly formed SHGs accessed loans totalling Rs.47.79 lakh, enabling members to establish and expand small-scale enterprises that enhanced household incomes and financial security. In addition, over 5,700 women secured employment through MGNREGA in RLHP intervention areas. Women's groups also actively engaged with Gram Panchayats to improved access to essential services, including drinking water, roads, housing, sanitation, and other community infrastructure, thereby strengthening grassroots governance and promoting inclusive community development.



3.2. INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY

RLHP observed International Women's Day across Basavakalyana, Chincholi, Gundlupete, Mysuru Urban, and Mysuru Rural, with more than 1,500 community women, including adolescent girls, participating in the celebrations. Government officials and other stakeholders also joined the programmes, strengthening awareness and collective action on women's rights and empowerment. The programmes highlighted women's achievements, resilience, leadership, and contributions to community development while promoting gender equality and women's rights.The programmes included sessions on gender equality, legal rights, prevention of gender-based violence, health and nutrition, menstrual hygiene, financial literacy,



leadership, and government schemes, along with sports, cultural programmes, motivational talks, discussions, and exhibitions of women's talents and products. The celebrations strengthened women's confidence, leadership, and collective participation, encouraging them to take active roles in decision-making and community development.

4. PEOPLE'S DEVELOPMENT

4.1. COLLABORATION WITH GOVERNMENT AND CAPACITATED EXISTING COMMUNITIES IN WARD AND VILLAGE LEVEL

Community participation is the foundation of sustainable development. RLHP conducted capacity-building programmes for rural and urban communities to identify and address local issues through collective action, strengthening social, economic, and cultural empowerment. The organization strengthened the capacity and engagement of existing community institutions, including School Development and Monitoring Committees (SDMCs), Village Health Sanitation and Nutrition Committees (VHSNCs), Block Resource and Support Social Groups (BRSSGs), Women and Child Protection Committees (WCPCs), Gram Panchayats, Child Marriage Prevention Officers (CMPOs), schoolteachers, ASHA workers, Anganwadi workers, and other key stakeholders to effective implementation and promote overall community development.

To strengthen community awareness and leadership, RLHP conducted a range of awareness campaigns and capacity-building programmes on health, education, livelihoods, and legal rights. The programmes covered key laws and government initiatives, including the Right to



Education Act, Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, POCSO Act, UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC), Panchayati Raj Act, 73rd Constitutional Amendment, ICDS, and prevention of teenage pregnancy. During the reporting period, more than 400,000 people participated in and benefited from RLHP's community development interventions.

RLHP has strengthened its collaboration with district and taluk administrations, Village Administrative Officers, Mysuru City Corporation Health Department, Women and Child Development Department, Education Department, and the District Child Protection Unit to improve community-level services and child protection mechanisms. Through



these partnerships, RLHP has supported capacity building and awareness programmes for frontline functionaries, including ASHA workers, Anganwadi Workers, PHCOs, CHOs, schoolteachers, RDPR officials, Panchayat Development Officers (PDOs), Panchayat Secretaries, Krishi Sakhis and Pashu Sakhis. These efforts have enhanced their knowledge and skills in health, nutrition, education, child protection, prevention of child marriage and child labour, government schemes, environmental awareness, and community mobilization. The collaboration has also promoted stronger coordination among government departments and grassroots institutions, enabling timely identification of community concerns, effective referrals, improved access to government services, and coordinated action for the well-being, safety and development of children, women and vulnerable communities.

4.2. REACHING THE UNREACHED THROUGH GOVERNMENT SCHEME LINKAGES

The Mass Contact Programme (MCP) is one of RLHP's key community engagement initiatives for strengthening community–government linkages and improving access to government schemes and public services. Through Application Melas, Labour Rights Orientation Programmes, Adolescent Girls Development Scheme (AGDS) meetings, and Community-Based Organization (CBO) Interface Meetings, communities were provided opportunities to interact directly with government officials, raise concerns, and access essential services and entitlements.

During the reporting period, MCPs were conducted across RLHP's rural and urban intervention areas, reaching more than 25,000 people. Representatives from Gram Panchayats, Taluk Panchayats, Labour, Health,



Education, and Women and Child Development Departments participated in these programmes. The initiatives supported communities in accessing social security, health, education, livelihood, housing, sanitation, and other government services.

Through collaboration with government departments and community participation, RLHP supported eligible individuals to access their entitlements, as detailed below:

Sl. No.	Service / Scheme	No. Facilitated
1	Pension Applications	92
2	Ayushman Bharat & ABHA Cards	4,288
3	Aadhaar Updates	25
4	Ration Card Applications	31
5	MGNREGA Job Card Applications	287
6	Job Card e-KYC Updates	3,829
7	e-Shram Registrations	500
8	Bank Account Openings	28
9	Income Certificates	43
10	Caste Certificates	43
11	PM Vishwakarma Applications	60
12	Labour Cards	42
13	Azim Premji Foundation Scholarships	66 Girls

Gaudanahalli Village: Improved Road and Bus Connectivity

Gaudanahalli village, under Garampalli Gram Panchayat in Chincholi Taluk, has 280 households and a population of 1,950. The village has a government school only up to Class 8. Poor road conditions and the lack of regular bus services created difficulties for students pursuing higher education. During a village visit, RLHP identified that several boys and girls had dropped out of school due to transportation challenges. Through community meetings, villagers collectively raised the issues of poor road connectivity and the lack of regular bus services. Petitions were submitted, and discussions were held with the concerned authorities, including the Bus Depot, Taluk Panchayat, and Tahsildar's Office, to seek a solution. Following continued efforts and coordination with the concerned departments, the road construction was completed, and regular bus services were introduced in the village. The improved connectivity enabled children to continue their education beyond Class 8 and improved villagers' access to hospitals, markets, government offices, and other essential services.

The MCPs contributed to improvements in housing, sanitation, education, health, drinking water, and community infrastructure. Eligible families were supported to access housing schemes such as PMAY and Basava Vasati Yojana, while household toilets, drainage, and drinking water facilities were promoted. School and Anganwadi infrastructure were improved through renovation, painting, toilet repairs, and other facility upgrades. SDMCs were also strengthened, a 2,000-litre drinking water tank with pipeline connection was installed at Chikkanigdhalli Government School, and Rs.50,000 worth of sports equipment was provi ded to Degalamadi Government Higher Primary School. Health camps were organized, and regular KSRTC bus services were facilitated in several villages, improving access to essential services.

Under employment and livelihood initiatives, more than 700 MGNREGA workers completed 12 weeks of employment and collectively earned Rs.1.81 crore. The initiative provided workers with sustained employment opportunities and a reliable source of income, helping to strengthen household earnings and improve livelihood security.

5. COMMUNITY-BASED HEALTH AND SANITATION

5.1. HEALTH CLINICS AND CAMPS FOR RURAL PEOPLE

RLHP conducted regular health clinics, medical camps, and outreach programmes to improve access to timely and affordable healthcare services in underserved communities. More than 6,300 people accessed healthcare services through these initiatives.

The health camps provided services including general health check-ups, screening for hypertension and diabetes, eye care, medical consultations, and referral services. More than 1,350 individuals with hypertension and diabetes were identified, monitored, and linked with government health facilities for continued treatment and follow-up. Eye care services benefited community members through 97



successful eye surgeries, while 158 individuals received eye check-ups and spectacles.

Through these health clinics and camps, RLHP strengthened access to essential healthcare services, encouraged early identification of health conditions, and promoted timely treatment and follow-up among vulnerable rural communities.

5.2. REPRODUCTIVE, MATERNAL AND CHILD HEALTH AND NUTRITION



RLHP focuses on improving the health and nutritional well-being of pregnant and lactating women and children through awareness, counselling, health education, and linkages with government health services. During the reporting period, 1,300 pregnant and lactating women received reproductive and maternal health education and were linked to government schemes such as Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY). They were also supported with Mother Cards to facilitate regular antenatal and postnatal care.

To address child malnutrition, 250



malnourished children received nutritious supplements, including Spirulina-chickpea powder. The intervention contributed to improvements in their nutritional status, physical growth, and cognitive development, while also supporting better attendance at schools and Anganwadi centres. Through these interventions, RLHP strengthened awareness of maternal and child health, improved access to essential services, and supported healthier growth and development among vulnerable children.

5.3. PREVENTIVE HEALTH MEASURES THROUGH MASS AWARENESS PROGRAMME

RLHP strengthened preventive healthcare through awareness and capacity-building activities focusing on personal hygiene, sanitation, nutrition, immunization, prevention of communicable and seasonal diseases, mental health, adolescent health, reproductive health, and healthy lifestyle practices. More than 250,000 people were reached through community-based awareness activities using street plays, video shows, flashcards, demonstrations, and meetings.



Capacity-building programmes for ASHA workers, Anganwadi workers, ANMs, Gram Panchayat members, and VHSNC members covered health-risk identification, maternal and childcare, tuberculosis prevention, climate change-related health risks, emergency preparedness, referral services, and access to government health services and welfare schemes.

These efforts improved community awareness, strengthened the capacity of local health functionaries, and encouraged early identification of health risks and timely preventive action.



Ensuring Safe Motherhood Through Timely Care

Mrs. Latha, a 35-year-old woman from Marashettalli Village, was expecting her third child and was concerned about her pregnancy due to her age and health condition. During a home visit, RLHP staff encouraged her to register her pregnancy, obtain her Thayi (Mother) Card, and attend regular antenatal check-ups. In her fifth month, she was diagnosed with high blood pressure and low haemoglobin, making her pregnancy high-risk. RLHP staff regularly visited her home to monitor her blood pressure, blood sugar, and weight, while counselling her on proper nutrition and self-care. She was advised to include iron-rich foods such as green leafy vegetables, pulses, and sprouts in her diet. She also attended RLHP organised health camps, where doctors provided regular guidance and reassurance. In the eighth month of pregnancy, she suddenly developed breathing difficulties. RLHP staff immediately referred her to District Hospital, where she received timely treatment and her condition stabilized. With continuous medical follow-up and support from RLHP, her health improved significantly. She later delivered a healthy baby girl weighing 2.8 kg through a normal delivery. Today, both mother and child are healthy.

6. STAFF DEVELOPMENT

6.1 CAPACITY BUILDING TRAINING FOR STAFFS

The strength of RLHP's programmes lies in the knowledge, commitment, and dedication of its 50 staff members, who work collectively to ensure effective programme implementation and meaningful impact in the communities served. To ensure high-quality implementation and sustainable impact, RLHP invests in continuous learning and professional development. Throughout the year, the organization conducted a range of capacity-building workshops, training programmes, exposure visits, and review meetings to enhance staff knowledge, technical skills, leadership abilities, and community engagement practices.

The training programmes covered a wide range of thematic areas, including child rights and protection, the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC), the Juvenile Justice (JJ) Act, the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, the Child Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, the Right to Education (RTE) Act, and the



Panchayati Raj Act. Staff also received training on child safeguarding, safe and unsafe touch, prevention of online abuse, gender equality, women's rights, the feminist movement, climate change, sustainable agriculture, Mission Vatsala, MGNREGA, report writing, vision building, leadership development, and results-based programme planning, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation. These sessions were facilitated by experienced resource persons from the development sector, providing valuable legal knowledge, practical skills, and field-based insights.

RLHP is committed to maintaining a safe,

inclusive, and child-friendly workplace. The organization has an active Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Committee, which meets quarterly, and implements a comprehensive Child Safeguarding Policy to ensure the safety and well-being of children and vulnerable individuals. In addition, staff participated in external training programmes, regular performance appraisals, and monthly review meetings that encouraged reflection, knowledge sharing, accountability, and continuous improvement. These ongoing investments in staff development have strengthened programme quality, enhanced organizational effectiveness, and enabled RLHP to deliver meaningful and sustainable impact in the communities it serves.

7. NETWORKING

7.1. PARTNERSHIPS-NETWORKING AND INSTITUTIONAL CONVERGENCE



RLHP continued to strengthen and sustain its network with like-minded organizations, government departments, academic institutions, national and international development agencies, and community-based organizations. Key collaborators included the Campaign Against Child Labour–Karnataka (CACL-K), Federation of Voluntary Organizations for Rural Development–Karnataka (FEVORD-K), Karnataka Child Rights Observatory (KCRO), Federation of Education Resource Centres (FERC), DWANI, MYTHRI, Mahila Dowrjanya Virodhi Okkuta, People's Action for Development Initiatives (PADI), Marathwada Grameena Vikasa Samstha (MGVS), ChildFund International, and the Central University of Karnataka (CUK), along with various government departments and civil society organizations. Throughout the year, RLHP co-organized state, national, and inter-state consultations, capacity-building programmes, policy dialogues, coordination meetings, and network-building initiatives that strengthened collaboration on child rights, quality education, child protection, migrant children's issues, and social justice. As the State Convener of the Campaign Against Child Labour–Karnataka (CACL-K), RLHP continued to lead collaborative efforts, influence policy dialogue, and mobilize stakeholders to protect and promote the rights and well-being of every child.

RLHP is honoured to continue serving as the State Convener of the Campaign Against Child Labour–Karnataka (CACL-K), a leading state-level network committed to eliminating child labour and promoting children's rights. Through this leadership role, RLHP convened key stakeholders from government, academia, and civil society to enhance advocacy, strengthen

policy implementation, and build the capacities of child rights defenders across Karnataka.

During the year, RLHP co-organized a three-day State-Level Empowerment Training Programme, "Changemakers towards Building a Child-Friendly Society," involving 55 participants from 31 districts. It also facilitated a State-Level Consultation on Quality Education and Child Rights Laws, bringing together over 70 representatives from government departments, KSCPCR, UNICEF, and child rights organizations to promote effective implementation of child protection laws. In addition, RLHP organized an Inter-State Consultation on Sugarcane Harvesting Migrant Families and Children, engaging 47 representatives from Karnataka and Maharashtra, and convened a District-Level Coordination Meeting in Bidar, where the District Administration issued directives to improve education, protection, and welfare services for migrant children and their families.

A district-level convergence workshop on child marriage prevention was organized at Kalamandira, Mysuru, in collaboration with the District Administration, Child Protection Department, Women and Child Development Department, Police and Education Departments, District Legal Services Authority, RLHP, ChildFund International and other stakeholders. The workshop brought together around 630 Child Marriage Prohibition Officers from district and taluka levels. District Commissioner G. Lakshmikanth Reddy emphasized the need for stronger inter-departmental coordination, accountability and timely intervention to prevent child marriages. Additional Deputy Commissioner Dr. P. Shivaraj highlighted the importance of education and community participation and urged citizens to report cases through Child Helpline 1098. Technical training on the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2016 and POCSO Act, 2012 was provided by Dr. K. Raghavendra Bhatt, UNICEF Child Protection Project, covering legal provisions, identification, reporting and preventive action. The programme also included an awareness rally, felicitation of essay competition winners and recognition of nine Anganwadi Supervisors for their contribution to preventing and reporting child marriages. The workshop strengthened institutional convergence and reaffirmed the collective commitment to making Mysuru a child-marriage-free district.



RLHP further expanded its inclusion initiatives by partnering with ABLE to create awareness among more than 300 persons with disabilities on the availability of assistive devices. Persons with disabilities from Roopanagar, Vasanthanagar, and PK Sanitorium were supported in accessing artificial limbs, orthotic belts, supportive footwear, and other mobility aids, improving their independence and quality of life. In addition, an eye screening camp organized in Roopanagar provided 35 people with spectacles, referred 15 individuals for advanced treatment, and reached 80 community members through an eye health awareness programme that encouraged regular eye check-ups and timely medical care.

8. OTHER EVENTS

8.1. SRI JOY MALIEKAL MEMORIAL HALL

During the reporting period, RLHP inaugurated its training hall in memory of its Founder, Sri Joy Maliekal, and dedicated it as the Sri Joy Maliekal Memorial Hall in recognition of his vision and lifelong contribution to community development.



8.2. YOUTH RESOURCE CENTRE

RLHP also established a Youth Resource Centre (YRC) at its Gundlupete office to provide adolescent girls and youth with a safe and engaging learning space. During the year, 665 adolescent girls from 25 villages visited the centre, where they read books, watched educational films, learned dance, played chess and carrom, and participated in recreational and life-enriching activities that promoted learning, creativity, and personal development.

8.3. EDUCATION MATERIALS DISTRIBUTION PROGRAMME



The Rural Literacy & Health Programme (RLHP), Mysuru, in collaboration with ChildFund International, organized an Education Materials Distribution and Awareness Programme on 12 July 2025 at Jaganmohan Palace, Mysuru. The programme aimed to support children from economically disadvantaged families and slum communities by providing essential educational materials, preventing school dropouts, and encouraging children to continue their education.

An awareness session on the Right to Education (RTE) Act, 2009 was conducted by education expert Dr. Niranjanaradhya V.P. The session highlighted education as a fundamental right and emphasized the important role of parents in supporting their children's education and academic development.

The inaugural ceremony was led by Shri Tanveer Sait, Hon'ble MLA, Narasimharaja

Constituency, with Shri Chandregowda, former Commissioner, Karnataka State Right to Information Commission, presiding over the event. Other dignitaries included Dr. Shivaraju P, Additional District Commissioner, Mysuru; Shri Javaregowda S.T., Deputy Director, School Education and Literacy, Mysuru; Ms. Shiny Jacob, Programme Specialist, ChildFund International; Prof. Jose V.K., Secretary, RLHP; and Smt. Saraswathi, Director, RLHP.

More than 1,600 children and parents participated in the programme. The event brought together children, parents, government officials, education representatives, ChildFund International, and RLHP, strengthening collective efforts to promote children's right to education and ensure continued access to learning opportunities.

8.4. RLHP–WIPRO COMMUNITY INITIATIVES

RLHP, in collaboration with Wipro volunteers, implemented a range of community initiatives in Mysuru focusing on menstrual hygiene, environmental conservation, child safety and sustainable practices. The activities included preparation and distribution of menstrual hygiene kits to rural adolescent girls, seed ball making and environmental conservation activities, sapling plantation programmes with school students, and reusable paper bag making to promote reduction of single-use plastics. Volunteers also prepared school first-aid kits to strengthen child safety and support safer learning environments. Greeting card-making and menstrual hygiene awareness activities were also organized to encourage



child participation and health awareness. These initiatives strengthened volunteerism, community participation, environmental responsibility, menstrual health awareness and child protection, demonstrating the positive impact of the RLHP–Wipro partnership in creating healthier, safer and more sustainable communities.

9. AUDITORS

PHILLIPOS GEORGE & CO., CHARTED ACCOUNTANT

10. CONCLUSION

As we look back on the year 2025–2026, the Rural Literacy and Health Programme (RLHP) marks another year of transformative journey, collective resilience, and deep-rooted commitment to the most marginalized and vulnerable communities across Karnataka. Over four decades of dedicated service have reinforced our belief that true community development occurs when marginalized groups—especially children, adolescent girls, and women—are empowered to lead, participate, and advocate for their own rights.

Throughout this past year, our integrated approach across the Mysuru, Chamarajanagar, Kalaburagi, and Bidar districts reached over 9.7 lakh individuals. From securing a safe, nurturing home for children in difficult circumstances at Asha Kirana and Asha Bhavana, to mobilizing young changemakers in environmental action, climate resilience, and child rights advocacy, RLHP has continued to expand its footprint and impact. Through Child Rights Clubs, Special Children's Gram Sabhas, and active adolescent leadership, we have witnessed young people step up as powerful advocates for education, equality, and protection within their communities.

Our work with women's federations, Self-Help Groups, and community governance bodies has further demonstrated the strength of grassroots collective action. By bridging the gap between underserved communities and essential government schemes, improving healthcare access, and fostering sustainable livelihoods, we are building self-reliant communities capable of creating lasting, generational change.

None of these achievements would have been possible without the unwavering support of our key partners, government departments, civil society networks, donors, corporate sponsors, and local governance institutions. I extend my deepest appreciation to the Governing Body, our dedicated staff members, grassroots community leaders, and volunteers whose relentless passion and hard work remain the backbone of RLHP.

As we move forward, RLHP remains steadfast in its core mission: reaching the unreached, eradicating child labour and abuse, advancing gender justice, and creating an inclusive, equitable, and sustainable environment where every child and individual can thrive with dignity.

Mrs. Saraswathi
Director, RLHP,
Mysore.









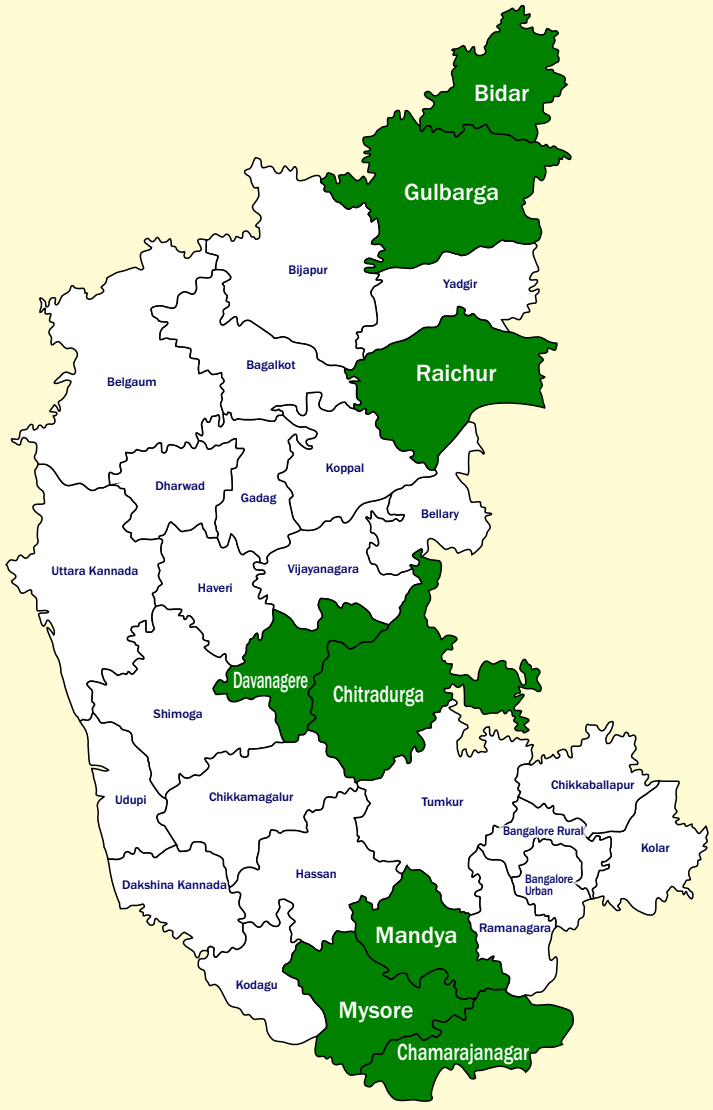






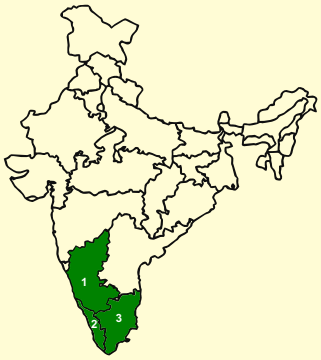


RLHP'S INTERVENTION AREAS



STATES

1. KARNATAKA
2. KERALA
3. TAMILNADU



KARNATAKA DISTRICTS

1. MYSORE
2. MANDYA
3. CHAMARAJANAGAR
4. BIDAR
5. KALABURGI
6. RAICHUR
7. CHITRADURGA
8. DAVANAGERE

RURAL LITERACY & HEALTH PROGRAMME (RLHP)

343, 2nd Stage, Gayathripuram, Udayagiri Post, Mysore - 570019 Phone : 0821-2451216 www.rlhpmysore.com